

fd: (platform) floppy disks, though this same abbreviation is also commonly used to refer to file descriptor

hd: (“classic”) IDE driver

hda: the master device on the first ATA channel

hdb: the slave device on the first ATA channel

hdc: the master device on the second ATA channel

hdd: the slave device on the second ATA channel

lp: line printers

parport, pp: parallel ports

pt: pseudo-terminals (virtual terminals)

SCSI driver, also used by libata (modern PATA/SATA driver), USB, Firewire, etc.

sd: mass-storage driver

sda: first registered device

ses: Enclosure driver

sg: generic SCSI layer

sr: “ROM” driver (data-oriented optical disc drives; scd is just a secondary alias)

st: magnetic tape driver

tty: terminals

ttyS: (platform) serial port driver

ttyUSB: USB serial converters, modems, etc.

This prefix is usually followed by a number which uniquely identifies the particular device. For hard drives an alphabet is used to identify the device and it is followed by a number to identify partitions. For example, `/dev/sda` corresponds to the entire disk and `/dev/sda1`, `/dev/sda2` correspond to the first and second partitions respectively.

2.2 Pseudo devices

In addition to corresponding to physical devices, device nodes also correspond to pseudo-devices that provides various functions handled by the operating system. Some of the most commonly used pseudo devices include:

`/dev/null`

`/dev/null` accepts all inputs and discards it. It produces no output. It is commonly used when the user has no use for the standard output and the program has no option to suppress standard output.

`/dev/zero`

This produces a continuous stream of zero value bytes.